

Ecuador



South America

Root crop

A small root vegetable similar to a potato, called **olluco**, grows in the Andes Mountains and is used in salads, soups, and stews in Ecuador.



Quito old town

The Spanish founded Quito in the 16th century, building it on the former site of an Inca city. The modern city center has retained its historic Spanish architecture.



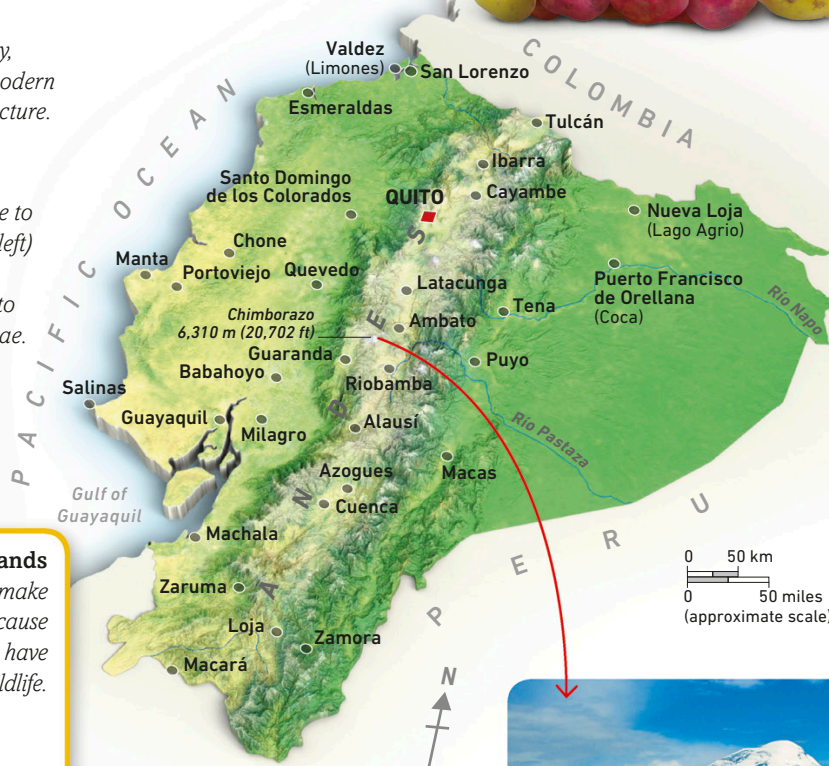
Galápagos iguanas

The Galápagos are home to land iguanas (pictured left) and unique marine iguanas that are able to swim and graze on algae.



Galápagos Islands

A group of 19 islands make up the Galápagos. Because they are so remote, they have evolved, unique wildlife.



Mount Chimborazo

The highest point in Ecuador is Mount Chimborazo, an inactive volcano with snow on its peak, standing 20,702 ft (6,310 m) high.



Textile market

In a town near Ibarra in northern Ecuador, the locals weave colorful woollen textiles. These are sold at local markets as well as abroad.



- 📏 109,483 sq miles (283,561 sq km)
- 👤 17 million
- ★ Quito
- 🗣️ Spanish, other languages (+2)

Ecuador, which sits on the **Equator**, is marked by the Andes Mountains and low-lying **coastal regions**. Lying about 620 miles (1,000 km) to the west in the Pacific Ocean, the **Galápagos Islands** also belong to Ecuador.